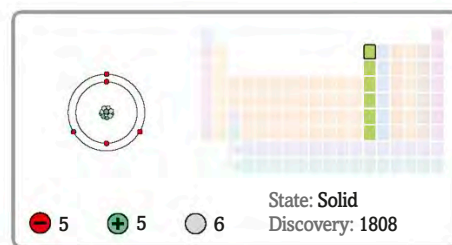


5

B

Boron



Forms

Ulexite



This translucent mineral is found in dried lakes.

Kernite



This is a colourless form of a compound of sodium and boron.

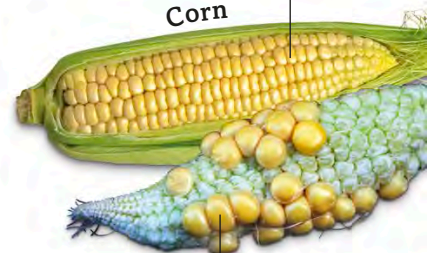
Laboratory sample of pure boron



Boron-deficient corn does not grow properly.

Boron-rich corn

Corn



This metal is dark and slightly shiny.

Colemanite



Some boron compounds are among the toughest artificial substances on Earth, with only diamond being harder. This element is a very hard material and becomes even harder when made to react with carbon or nitrogen. **Pure boron** can be extracted from various minerals,

including **ulexite** and **kernite**. The demand for this element was once so high that people moved to live in the extreme heat of **Death Valley, USA**, to work in boron mines there. Compounds of boron in soil are essential for plants to grow healthily. We use boron in our homes every day.